

Note Perfect

Notebooks come at a premium, but for anyone who needs to be mobile, it's a premium that's worth paying. Laptops generally lag considerably behind desktop PCs in absolute performance, and upgrades can be really expensive. Compaq, Toshiba, IBM, and Dell dominate the international laptop market.

Smart Tips

Size/weight: The weight ranges from 1.5 kg to 4 kg and it could be as little as 1-inch thick. External power supplies and peripherals can add considerably to the weight.

Display: This will require a compromise if you decide on an ultraportable model. Most displays now support 1024 x 768 pixels and a 14-inch notebook display may be larger than most 15-inch desktop CRT units.

Processor: While the Crusoe, Duron and Athlon mobile processors are available, Intel's mobile processors are more popular.

Battery: Realistically, the uptime for most Lithium-ion battery powered models is about three to four hours.

Keyboard: If you are going to be doing a lot of typing, a larger keyboard will add considerably to your comfort. Having the eight cursor-control keys is very important.



Drives/bays: Though, it makes sense to have all drives (floppy, DVD/CD ROM) built into the main casing, a hot-swappable bay gives you greater flexibility.

Hard drive: Capacity ranges from 6 GB to 50 GB. Most users find 12-20 GB enough. Anyway you will not save much by buying a smaller capacity HDD, and will pay a lot more to buy a bigger capacity drive.

Communication: Look for a built-in 56 Kbps modem with a RJ-45 connector for your phone line. If you spend a lot of time on a network, you will also want a built-in Ethernet port. While IrDA

is available on many units, this has not really been a popular option.

Pointing device: You can choose between a pointing stick (like IBMs Trackpoint), or a touch pad. Pointers are easier to control but can give you a sore finger especially if used for a long stretch of time.

Ports: Most peripheral devices connect to a USB port; make sure you have at least two USB ports. You will also need parallel (for printers), serial, and PS/2 (for keyboard/mice) ports.

Docking stations: This is useful if you are using your notebook as a desktop replacement.

Decision Maker

	Entry level	Desktop replacement	Ultraportable
You need	A purely functional device that offers what any casual user might need, at affordable prices.	Something that gives a high performance, and has several extra features as well	An ultra light notebook; something with a bit more panache
Look for	A model that has an extra bay that would hold a CD/DVD-ROM, floppy drive, add-on battery or even a CD-RW drive. These generally will offer a 13/14-inch XGA display and weigh less than 3 kg	Something that gives you all the functionality of your existing desktop PC	Extremely lightweight devices that are different from the crowd
Our pick	ACi Ethos 4	ACi Emerald Pro	Toshiba Protégé 3500
Price range	Rs 1,00,000 and below	Rs 1,00,000 to Rs 1,50,000	About Rs 2,00,000

F R A N C H I S E E N Q U I R I E S S O L I C I T E D

SERVICE

If your Laptop Is

DELL

COMPAQ

hp

IBM

Jaguar
Product of MICROD

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unbelievable
upgrade cost.

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service centre

Planet
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